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Team: 363738

DATATHON 2026

[SUBAA X ACCENTURE]



CONTENTS

1 Situation & Problem Statement

3 Evidence

5 Solutions

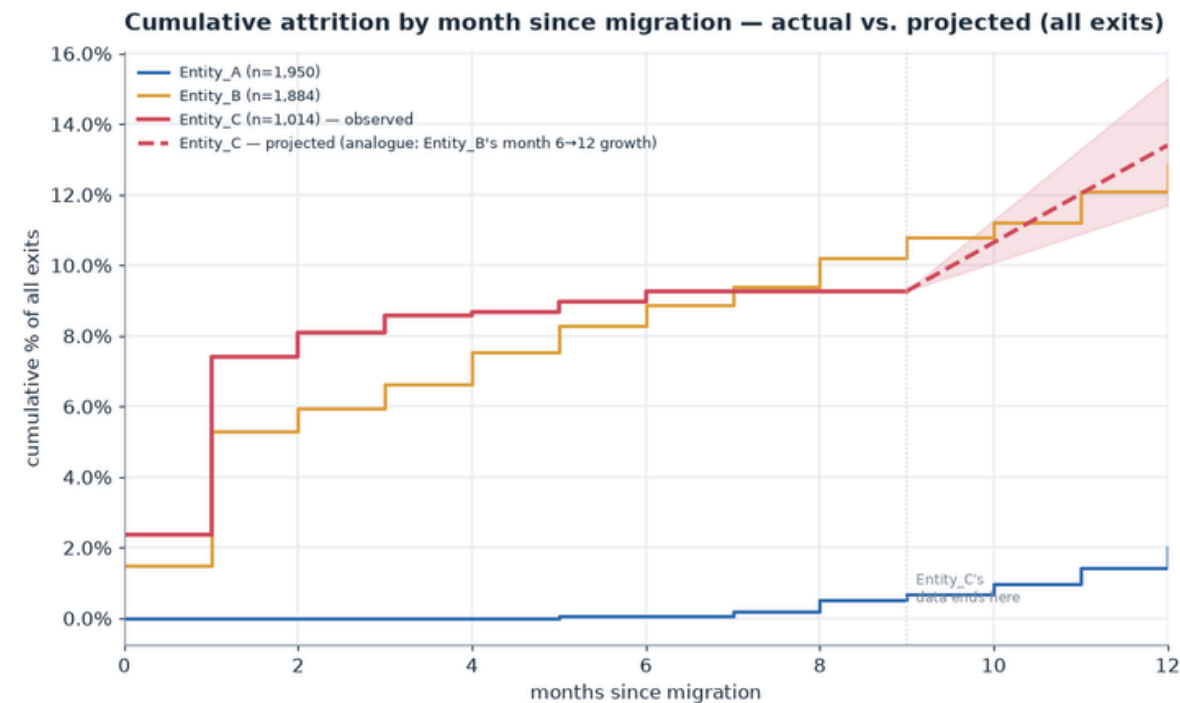
2 Findings & Interpretation

4 Cost

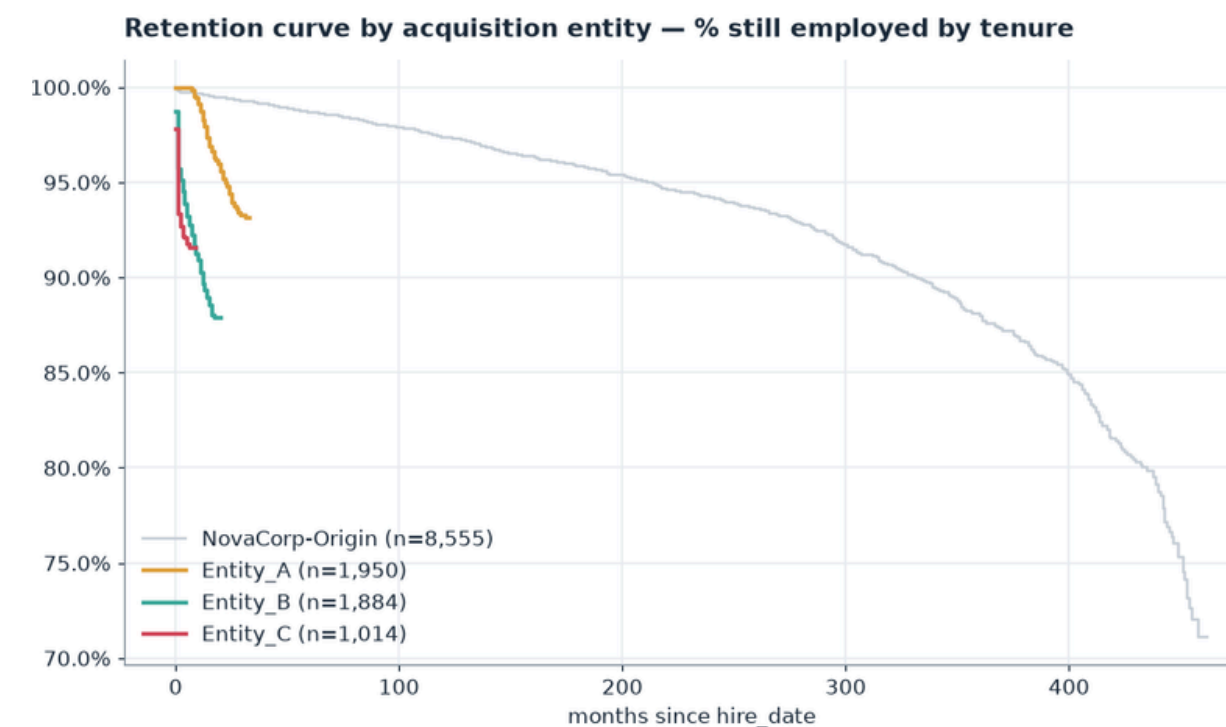
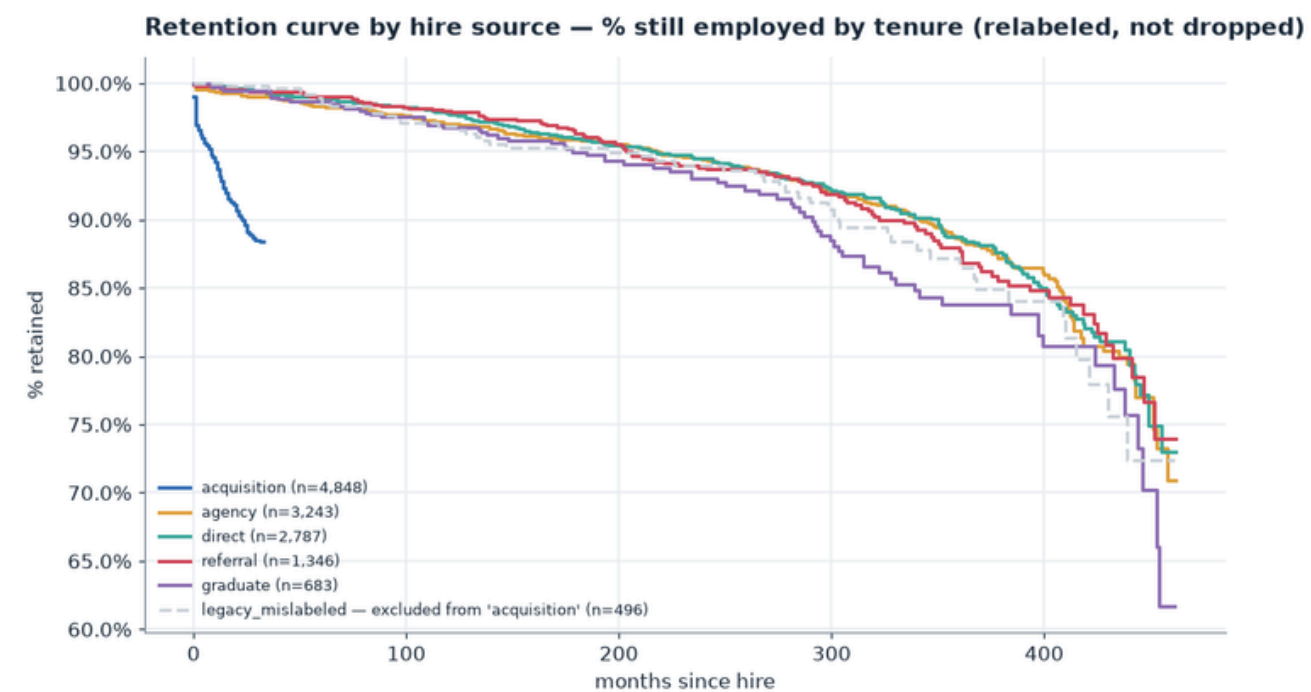
6 Limitations & Ethics

PROBLEM STATEMENT

The driver of NovaCorp's attrition is acquisition and each integration has gone worse than the last.



- Entity_B: 12.8% cumulative loss by month 12.
- Entity_C: 9.3% at month 6 — on pace for 11.7-15.3% by month 12 if it mirrors Entity_B
- Entity_A: no month 1-6 data (predates data window)



Within roughly two years, acquired-entity retention has already fallen to 88-93% — a level NovaCorp-Origin doesn't reach until nearly 20 years of tenure.

FINDINGS & INTERPRETATION

WHAT DOES NOT WORK

"We have a high-potential retention problem."

→ Excess HiPo attrition sits where potential and realised performance diverge — not among the strongest performers.

"Regrettable attrition tells us what we lost."

→ That flag is an HR judgement recorded after the exit. HiPos are 12.9% of departures but 49.7% of regrettable ones.

"Entity_C looks fine — its attrition is low."

→ Attrition is the lagging measure. C's survey participation and organisational sentiment already resemble early Entity_B.

OUR INTERPRETATION

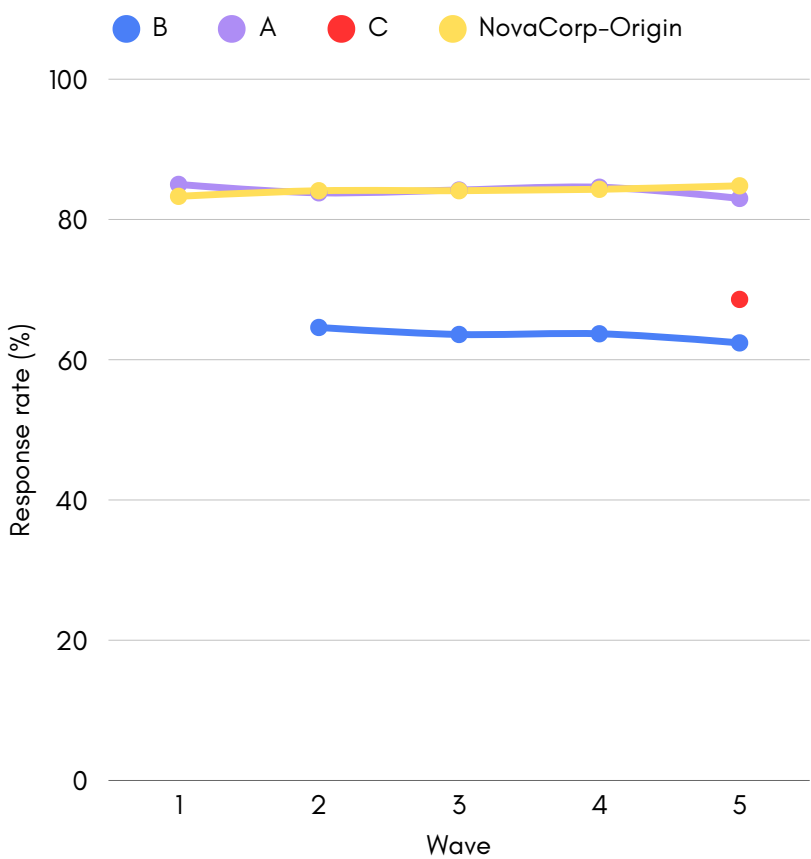
Acquisition integration creates friction that shows up in survey participation and organisational sentiment months before people leave — and Entity_C is showing that pattern now.

The next five slides give the evidence, one finding at a time.

ENTITY_B STOPPED ANSWERING

63.4%

of surveys answered by Entity_B
versus 84.1% in mature cohorts



- **Population.** All 5,932 surveys issued to Entity_B employees across waves 2-5; 3,763 answered. Benchmark is Entity_A plus NovaCorp-Origin, 49,106 surveys issued.
- **It never recovers.** Wave-by-wave: 64.6%, 63.6%, 63.7%, 62.4%. The gap is flat across every wave Entity_B has been observed.
- **Scale.** 1,227 responses short of what the mature-cohort rate would have produced — roughly a fifth of Entity_B's workforce voice, missing.

What this shows

A persistent, entity-specific participation deficit that is not explained by survey timing — Entity_A, acquired earlier, sits at the benchmark.

What it does NOT show

Why people are silent. Non-response is not directly observed disengagement, and we have no pre-acquisition baseline for Entity_B.

TWO DIMENSIONS ARE DOWN, SIX ARE FINE

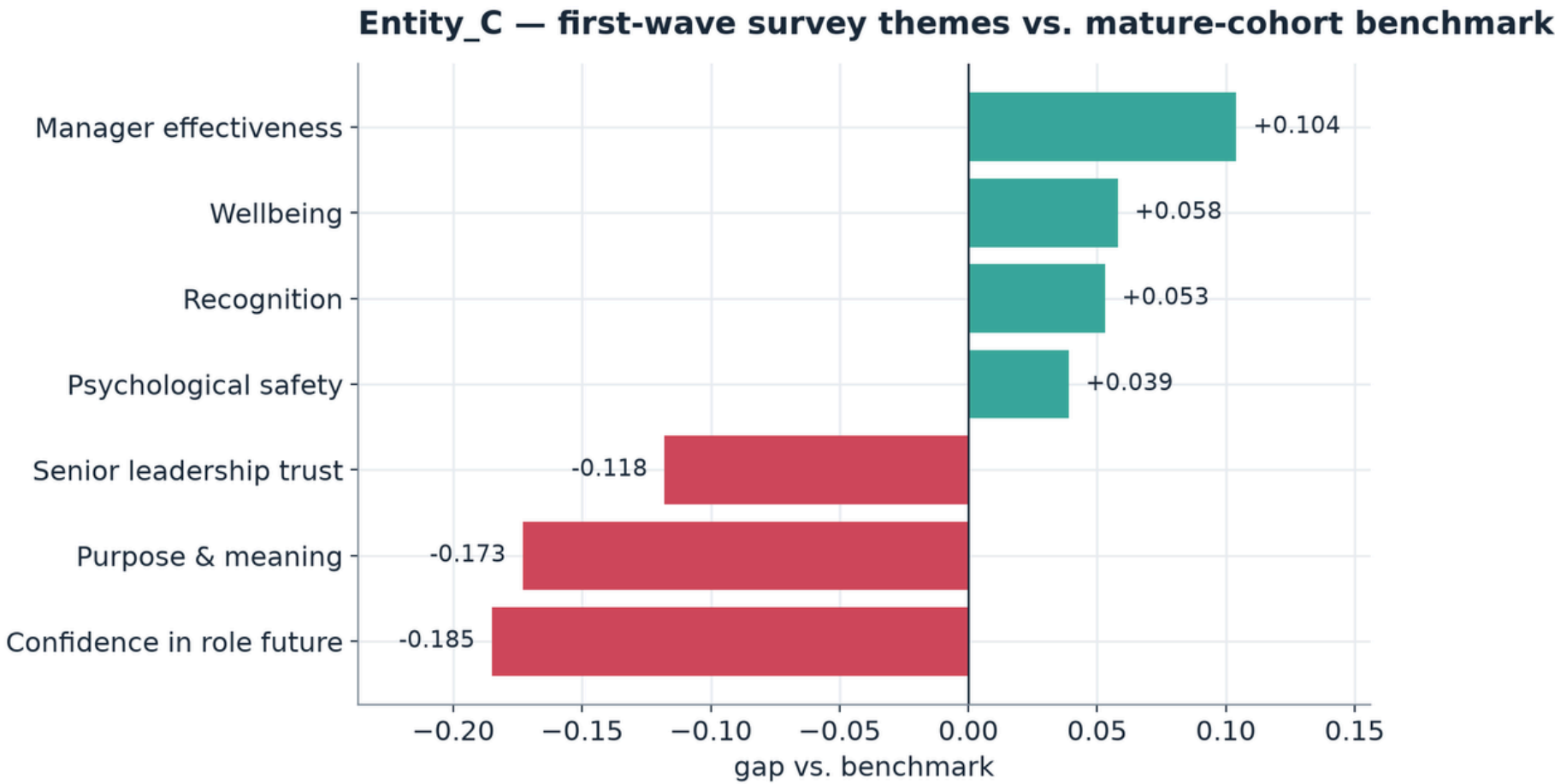
Among Entity_B employees who did answer, the deficit is narrow and specific — it sits at the organisational level, not the team level.

ENGAGEMENT DIMENSION	ENTITY_B	MATURE	GAP
Senior leadership trust	3.06	3.38	-0.33
Purpose & meaning	3.06	3.38	-0.32
Career development	3.32	3.38	-0.05
Wellbeing	3.34	3.38	-0.04
Recognition	3.35	3.38	-0.02
Psychological safety	3.36	3.37	-0.02
Confidence in role future	3.37	3.38	-0.01
Manager effectiveness	3.38	3.36	+0.02

What this shows
The deficit is about the organisation as a whole — trust in senior leadership and sense of purpose — not about local managers, who score at or above benchmark.
It is also stable: the same two dimensions are down in all four of Entity_B's waves, and employees who answered more than once show little recovery.

What it does NOT show
That the merger caused it. No pre-acquisition survey exists, so this is an association measured after the fact.

ENTITY_C IS SHOWING THE SAME SIGNATURE



What this shows

The same shape as Entity_B: participation down, and the deficits confined to organisation-level items while day-to-day management measures are healthy. Entity_C's attrition rate is currently low — but on the Entity_B precedent, attrition is the last thing to move.

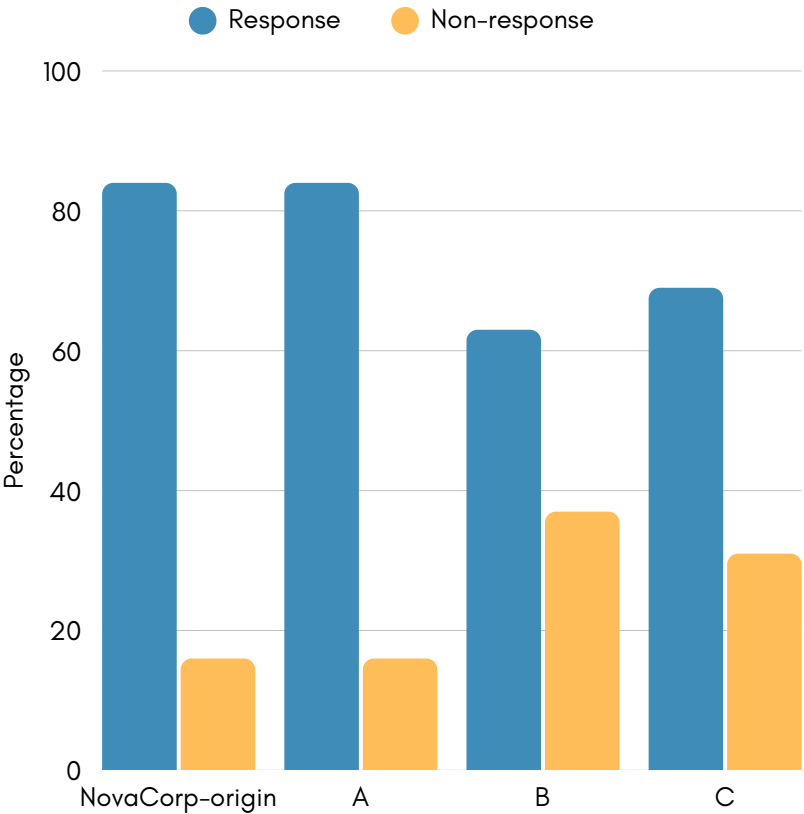
What it does not show

That Entity_C will repeat Entity_B. One survey wave cannot establish a trajectory, and Entity_C has no second wave to confirm persistence. This is a reason to monitor and act early, not a forecast.

SILENCE COMES BEFORE THE EXIT

2×

the exit rate among non-responders
7.0% vs 3.6% within 180 days



- **Population.** Entity_B survey observations with a full 180 days of follow-up available: 1,551 non-responses and 2,737 responses.
- **Replicates.** The same direction appears in Entity_A and NovaCorp-Origin, so this is not an Entity_B quirk.
- **Measured properly.** Without censoring for incomplete follow-up the gap looks smaller (5.8% vs 3.3%). The censored figure is the defensible one and we quote it.

What this shows

Survey silence is a leading indicator, not merely missing data. It is visible roughly six months before the departures it precedes.

What it does NOT show

That any individual who stays silent will leave. This is a cohort-level warning signal and must be read at team or entity level — never used to flag a named employee.

THE HIPO RISK IS DIVERGENCE, NOT STATUS

Excess high-potential attrition is concentrated where the potential designation and later realised performance disagree.

PERFORMANCE BAND	HIPO ATTRITION	NON-HIPO	HIPO GROUP SIZE
Bottom 20%	21.7%	4.2%	23
20-40%	16.1%	7.4%	87
40-60%	2.4%	1.4%	127
60-80%	1.4%	1.6%	211
Top 20%	7.1%	8.3%	636

Pooled bottom 40%

17.3%

HiPo (19 of 110)
vs 6.1% non-HiPo (289
of 4,756)

What this shows

A marker that is visible at least six months before departure, and one NovaCorp can act on — because it is built from performance the business already records.

What it does not show

Why these people leave. Only 2 of the 19 departures were performance-managed, so this is not managed exit. Poor fit, stalled development, changed motivation and talent-review error cannot be separated with this data, and the subgroup is small.

WHAT EACH MECHANISM IS WORTH

Every figure below is an exposure estimate under a stated assumption, not an audited loss.

BUCKET	FINANCE	OURS	FORMULA AND ASSUMPTION
Regrettable attrition	\$22-25M	\$30.0M	153 HR-flagged regrettable departures × 1.5 × salary at exit. The 1.5× replacement multiplier is an assumption; no backfill rate is applied. Departed population only.
Disengagement	\$12-15M	\$14.7M	734 employees × 15% of salary (Finance's productivity assumption). Threshold is analyst-defined, so we show the range : \$10.8M at a stricter cut, \$19.7M at a looser one.
Hiring inefficiency	\$4-6M	\$4.57M	274 agency hires in 2024-25: \$6.07M in fees (18% of salary) less a \$1.51M direct-hire benchmark (\$5,500 each). The cleanest of the three.
FAR / Risk & Compliance	—	~\$3.1M	Model-estimated 14.6 excess senior pull exits × \$140,215 average salary × 1.5. Moderate confidence only — no pre-FAR baseline, so this is not a causal estimate.

Where it concentrates: high-potential departures account for \$14.86M — 49.6% — of the reconstructed attrition cost, and still \$8.28M (27.6%) after excluding both Entity_B and Risk & Compliance.

ENTITY_C LEADERSHIP-TRUST INTERVENTION

\$5–15M

modelled benefit

if Entity_C's trajectory is contained rather than left to mirror Entity_B

OWNER

CHRO + Integration Lead

COST

Leadership time and communication cadence — no material programme budget.

- **Act on the survey signature, not the attrition rate.** Entity_C's wave-5 pattern already matches Entity_B's early signature. Non-response leads departures by roughly six months (Evidence 3), and on the Entity_B precedent attrition is the last thing to move (Evidence 4).
- **Four actions.**
 - (1) Executive town hall plus written communication on the integration roadmap and role security, delivered by senior leadership directly, within 30 days.
 - (2) Monthly “role future” briefing for Entity_C.
 - (3) Accelerate wave 6 to a 60-day cycle to confirm or disconfirm the Entity_B pattern.
 - (4) Formalise this trigger as a standing playbook for future acquisitions.

EXTEND TO ENTITY_B NOW · SAME MECHANISM, HIGHER CONFIDENCE

- **Extend the same intervention to Entity_B now.** Entity_B shows the identical signature (Evidence 1-2: 63.4% response vs. 84.1% mature, -0.33 leadership trust, -0.32 purpose) — larger population, and the damage is already realized rather than projected, so this is the higher-confidence, higher-volume application of the same fix already justified for Entity_C.

\$1.0M

prevented disengaged headcount

if closed to mature baseline (~51 people)

\$12.5M

prevented forward attrition

illustrative — assumes ~70% of Entity_B's population still carries meaningful forward tenure risk; not measured

\$13.6M

combined Entity_B extension

brings Recommendation 1 to \$18.6–28.6M total across both entities

MARK POTENTIAL–PERFORMANCE DIVERGENCE FLAG

~\$2.8M

modelled benefit

if the flagged group's attrition converges to the non-HiPo bottom-40% baseline

OWNER

Talent Review Panel + line managers

COST

Near-zero — built on data already collected; the primary cost is manager time.

- **Flag divergence, not HiPo status.** Automated flag: HiPo and bottom-40% performance-within-level for two consecutive review cycles. This reuses Evidence 5's exact population of 110 people — no new data collection.
- **A structured, informal conversation, not a performance plan.** Only 2 of the 19 departures in this group were formally performance-managed, so treating this as underperformance risks may undervalue their abilities.
- **Run as a monitored pilot for two review cycles before scaling.** The mechanism behind these departures such as fit, development, motivation, or talent-review error is not yet known.

RESPONSE-RATE KPI AND AGENCY DISCIPLINE

\$1.37M

direct agency-spend saving

shift roughly a third of agency hiring to direct/referral channels

\$4.57M

agency premium already measured

274 agency hires; \$6.07M in fees against a \$1.51M direct-hire benchmark

OWNER

HR Analytics (KPI) · Talent Acquisition (agency cap)

COST

Near-zero for the KPI; cost-negative for the cap — it is a reallocation of spend already committed.

- **Redirect part of the saving into a referral bonus pool** for the affected roles.
- **Make survey response rate a standing KPI**, reported by entity and department every wave. This operationalises Evidence 3 — non-response carries twice the exit rate. Set a 75% floor; two consecutive misses trigger an HR leadership review.
- **Cap discretionary agency hiring** for role families where direct and referral fill-time is comparable, targeting a portion of the \$4.57M measured premium.

WHAT THIS PORTFOLIO ADDRESSES

A running total, stated as a range — not a false-precision point figure.

RECOMMENDATION	MODELLED VALUE	BASIS
Recommendation 1 — Entity_C + Entity_B leadership-trust intervention	\$18.6–28.6M	Entity_C \$5–15M (slide 11) + Entity_B extension \$13.6M, same mechanism (Evidence 1–4).
Recommendation 2 — Potential-performance divergence flag	~\$2.8M	If the flagged group's attrition converges to the non-HiPo bottom-40% baseline (Evidence 5).
Recommendation 3 — Response-rate KPI + agency discipline	\$1.37M direct + KPI value	Direct agency-spend saving measured; KPI value is preventive, not separately quantified.
Portfolio total	~\$23–33M	Sum of the three tracks above, kept as a range because Recommendation 1 already is one.

Roughly **55–79%** of Finance's stated \$42M exposure, or roughly **44–63%** of the analysis's own \$52.4M reconstruction including the FAR/R&C exposure (slide 10).

WHAT THIS DATA CANNOT SUPPORT

Taken from the analysis's own rejected and unsupported findings list — not written after the fact.

- **Demographics were audited, not modelled.** Gender, age band and cultural background were tested for disparity; none was found at aggregate level. They are not used to predict or target anyone, and local or intersectional effects cannot be ruled out.
- **No causal claims.** There is no pre-acquisition or pre-FAR baseline. Every integration finding is an association observed after the event. We describe what precedes what, never what causes what.
- **Retrospective HR fields are judgements.** Regrettable flag, performance band at exit, stated exit reason, pathway and exit type are all recorded after someone has left. Performance band at exit matches the nearest formal review only 27.7% of the time, so we use these to describe losses — never to predict them.
- **Tested and rejected — not used here.** Blanket HiPo underpayment as the mechanism; low performers simply being managed out; engagement profiles predicting push versus pull exits; persistent manager grading bias; agency hires having worse retention.
- **Thin cells, flagged where they appear.** Entity_C has one survey wave. The divergence subgroup is 110 HiPos and 19 departures. Acting appointments cover 82 employees, 8 of them HiPo — too rare for inference.
- **One conflict is unresolved.** Two definitions of push versus pull exits disagree (68% push against 66% pull). Both are defensible readings of retrospective fields, so neither appears on any evidence slide. See the appendix note.
- **Dollar figures are exposure, not loss.** Each rests on a stated multiplier and an analyst-set threshold. Change the assumption and the figure moves — the disengagement bucket ranges from \$10.8M to \$19.7M across reasonable cuts.